

Smaran Pokharel

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Education

Dakota State University

B.S. Computer Science (AI Specialization), Minor in Mathematics

GPA: 4.0 | President's Academic Honors List | DSU Rising & Champion Scholarship

Relevant Coursework: Object-Oriented Design, Software Security, Data Structures

Madison, SD

Expected May 2028

Competitions & Achievements

HiveCTF – Competitor

1st Place, (Feb 2026)

Solved advanced challenges in web exploitation, cryptography, and reverse engineering, achieving top performance within the Dakota State University bracket.

Ignite Hackathon – Full Stack Developer

Participation, (Apr 2026)

Developed an AI-powered terminal-based RPG integrating LLM-driven guidance to teach Linux commands through interactive gameplay.

Nepal-US Hackathon – Lead Backend / AI Developer

Participation, (Feb 2026)

Built an AI-driven task planner using LangGraph and OpenAI, enabling dynamic scheduling and calendar integration for adaptive workload management.

NCAE Cyber Games Regionals 2026 – Database and Router

5th Place, (Feb 2026)

Defended a simulated enterprise network by maintaining critical services, monitoring traffic, and mitigating attacks under real-time adversarial conditions.

Cybersports LTD CTF Summit – Competitor

4th Place, (Oct 2026)

Solved capture-the-flag challenges across web security, reverse engineering, and digital forensics in a competitive timed environment.

Projects

Terminal Quest

Ignite Hackathon | github.com/MrFiscus/TerminalQuest

Apr 2026 - Present

- Built a terminal-based dungeon RPG teaching Linux commands via file-system navigation.
- Integrated Claude AI for adaptive gameplay, level generation, and tutoring.

HandAll

Nepal-US Hackathon | github.com/MrFiscus/HandAll

Jan 2026 - Mar 2026

- Built an AI-powered planner that dynamically schedules and rebalances tasks.
- Engineered planning logic using LangGraph, OpenAI, and calendar integration.

Fiscus Films

Personal Project | github.com/MrFiscus/FiscusFilms

Dec 2024 - Present

- Developed a responsive film showcase platform using React, TypeScript, and Vite.

Experience & Leadership

Peer Tutor

Madison, SD

Trojans Tutoring

Jan 2025 – Present

Deliver one-on-one tutoring sessions across technical subjects, adapting explanations to individual learning styles and improving student comprehension and performance.

Front Desk Officer

Madison, SD

Dakota State University

Apr 2026 – Present

Manage front desk operations by coordinating service requests, handling communications, and ensuring efficient day-to-day administrative workflow.

Treasurer

Madison, SD

DSU International Club

Aug 2021 – Present

Manage and allocate club budgets to fund events for 250+ members, ensuring efficient resource use and financial accountability.

Technical Skills

Programming: JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, C/C++, C#, SQL, Bash | **Frontend:** React, Vite, Tailwind CSS, HTML/CSS | **Backend:** Node.js, Express, FastAPI, REST APIs **Databases:** PostgreSQL, SQLite, Supabase | **AI/ML:** OpenAI API, LangGraph, LLM Integration | **Tools:** Git, GitHub, Docker, Postman, VS Code **Systems:** Linux/Unix, CLI Tools